

TONE OF VOICE

Voice principles
Voice tactics

Voice principles

Our tone of voice is how we activate our brand feel in everything we type and say. It's the tone, rhythm, punctuation, sentence length, and word choices that help our audiences hear, recognize, and remember us.

Our voice principles are inspired by our Brand Feel and Brand Attributes, which together influence the brand experience we want to create.

Think of these principles like checks and balances. No one rule reigns supreme; instead, they complement each other, so keep all four in mind as you draft your message.

How we write

1. WRITE BIG AND **BOLD**
2. BE **OPTIMISTIC** AND DETERMINED
3. GET **PERSONAL**—SPEAK LIKE ONE OF US
4. YOU'RE NOT WRITING—YOU'RE **MOTIVATING**

Voice tactics:
Write big and bold

Here are a few ways to make your copy feel big and bold.

Get to the point:
Use the fewest words possible to keep copy simple, digestible, and succinct.

Add urgency, now:
Use present tense markers (e.g., “now,” “today”) to emphasize facts and calls to action.

GET TO THE POINT

DO THIS

- 1. “GE Vernova businesses’ installed base grew 13%, and renewable energy and lower-carbon power generation technologies increased 16% during this past year.”
- 2. “GE Vernova’s flexible and scaleable Distributed Control System — SmartControl — enhances hydropower plant operation, helping reduce machine wear and subsequent maintenance costs.”

NOT THIS

- 1. “GE Vernova is focused on addressing the energy challenges by enabling the safe and reliable connection of renewable and distributed energy resources to the grid while growing our installed base.”
- 2. “Hydro control systems are specifically designed to help our customers get the most out of their hydro power plants.”

ADD URGENCY, NOW

- 1. “By acting now, we can make a meaningful impact.”

- 1. “Species are going extinct.”

Voice tactics:
Be optimistic

Here are a few ways to make your copy feel determined, and positive.

Take the lead:

Use imperative phrases and “must” to command actions.

Always get better:

Use positive comparatives (e.g., “faster,” “higher”) to inspire excitement and pride.

TAKE THE LEAD

DO THIS

- 1. “Be the energy of change.”
- 2. “We’re setting a new bar and new expectations from here — for the company we are today — to ensure we are leading the world forward into the next decade and beyond.”

NOT THIS

- 1. “You have to fight for change.”
- 2. “We need to hold ourselves to tougher expectations than we did yesterday — and even higher ones tomorrow and into the future.”

ALWAYS GET BETTER

- 1. “We can deliver more energy to more homes.”
- 1. “We need to deliver sustainable energy to homes around the world.”

Voice tactics:
Get personal

Here are a few ways to make your copy feel personal.

Leave no doubt:

Use factual sentences instead of conditionals or hypothetical questions to sound definitive.

Call on your team:

Use first person plurals (e.g., “we,” “our,” “let’s”) to speak to a united team. Externally, use “GE Vernova” and try to avoid pronouns.

LEAVE NO DOUBT

DO THIS

- 1. “We evolved our mission statement — electrify to thrive and decarbonize — a subtle, but intentional shift in how we approach the work we do.”
- 2. “Our diverse and experienced leadership team brings deep industry and public company expertise to drive long-term shareholder value.”

NOT THIS

- 1. “If we act now to address the climate crisis, we can provide electricity for more people.”
- 2. “What is special about GE’s digital approach?”

CALL ON YOUR TEAM

- 1. “GE Vernova brings the energy of change to the world.”
- 2. “Let’s get to work.”

- 1. “We are working harder than ever to change the world.”
- 2. “Get to work.”

Voice tactics:
Be motivational

Here are a few ways to make your copy feel motivational.

Mean the max:

Use strong verbs with precise meanings to keep interest and avoid repetition.

Get active:

Use active voice (e.g., subject-verb-object) instead of passive (e.g., object-verb-subject).
When talking about feelings, use passive.

MEAN THE MAX

DO THIS

- 1. “We must deliver for our customers.”
- 2. “We are uniting our businesses under one banner.”

NOT THIS

- 1. “We have to deliver for our customers.”
- 2. “We are moving our businesses under one banner.”

GET ACTIVE

- 1. “Purpose powers every action.”

- 1. “Every action is powered by purpose.”